

your self-awareness and keeps your mind limber and open. And these foreign skills, such as language and cultural understanding, could prove to be very financially valuable in the coming years as wealth shifts from the developed to the emerging world.

People in the developing world understand and respect family business, more so than in the United States. In Latin America and Asia, family businesses are more ubiquitous than in North America. It can be reassuring for them to do business with a family member of the business owner, rather than an unrelated employee.

We create internship opportunities for our family members and friends as often as possible. These internships are not just in our family business, but also in the businesses of friends and colleagues. Sometimes these develop into careers, sometimes not. But the experience helps young people learn about themselves and what they want from their work.

Also, you never know where the next business superstar is going to come from. The college roommate of your younger author is now a valuable employee in our family business.

HOW TO BRING “OUTSIDERS” INTO THE FAMILY

The introduction of an “outsider” into the family dynamic can be tricky. And the statistics are not encouraging. Half of all marriages fail.

In our business experience, too, we find that it is difficult to import upper-level employees. Typically, people enter as very young adults. They absorb the culture of the business. They fit in. Outsiders often don’t fit in.

But families must bring in outsiders. Sons and daughters will marry outsiders. You naturally want to protect your children and your family wealth. But you also know of the potential pitfalls involved in meddling in your children’s love lives!

The family, by way of the Family Council, should make policies regarding spouses. That’s because you don’t want to make decisions like this on a case-by-case basis. That could create feelings of bias and even